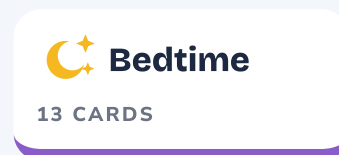
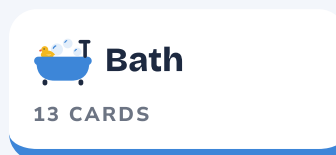
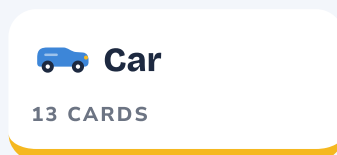
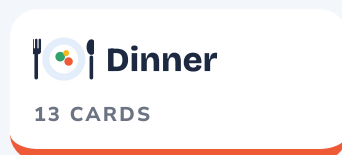
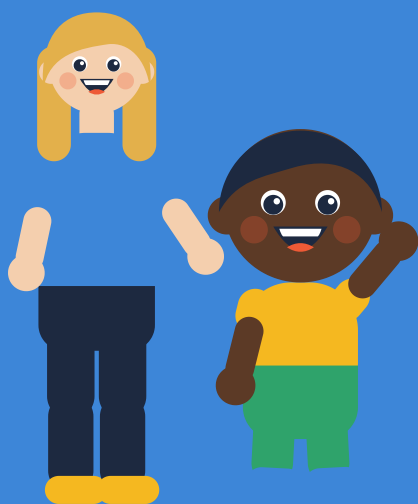


# 52 Family Talk-Along Cards

Good questions for dinner, the car, bath time  
and bedtime.



## Inside this download

- ✓ 54 poker-size cards: 52 questions, a how-to card and a blank
- ✓ 9 cards per page, with cut lines and card backs
- ✓ Make-your-own cards you can type into
- ✓ Cut-out labels for jars, bags and the glove box
- ✓ Grown-up guide with 6 easy talk-along habits
- ✓ US Letter and A4, full color and ink-saver

# Start here

Real talk happens in small moments: passing the peas, waiting at a red light, rinsing shampoo, turning off the lamp. These cards give those moments a good question.

## How to use the cards

- 1 Match the card to the moment.**  
Dinner cards at the table, car cards on the road, bath cards at the tub, bedtime cards at lights-out.
- 2 One card is plenty.**  
A single good question can fill a whole meal. Put the rest back for tomorrow.
- 3 Everyone answers.**  
Grown-ups too. Kids open up when they hear your answer first.
- 4 Use the grown-up tip.**  
Each card has one small idea for keeping the talk going.
- 5 Keep it light.**  
Anyone can say “pass.” It’s a conversation, not a quiz.

## Four moments

|                                                                                   |                |                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <b>Dinner</b>  | <b>CARDS 01–13</b><br>Keep them in a jar on the table.             |
|  | <b>Car</b>     | <b>CARDS 14–26</b><br>Keep them in the glove box or a door pocket. |
|  | <b>Bath</b>    | <b>CARDS 27–39</b><br>Keep them by the sink in a zip bag.          |
|  | <b>Bedtime</b> | <b>CARDS 40–52</b><br>Keep them on the nightstand or by the books. |

**Ages 5–7.** Read the card aloud, give an example answer, and welcome short answers. Drawing an answer counts too.

**Ages 8–12.** Let them read the card and choose who answers first. Ask the question back later in the week.

## 6 talk-along habits

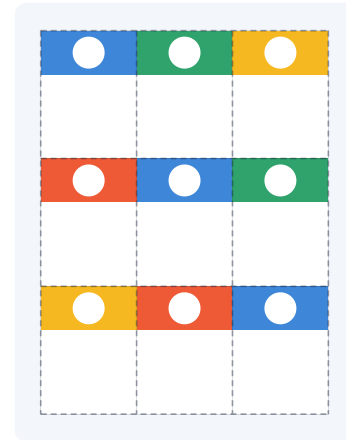
|                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |
| <b>Go first</b><br>Answer the card yourself sometimes.<br>Kids copy what they see.  | <b>Ask “what else?”</b><br>One gentle follow-up keeps a short answer going.         | <b>Side by side</b><br>Car rides and dish duty feel easier than face-to-face talks.   |
|  |  |  |
| <b>Wait longer</b><br>Count to five in your head. Big thoughts take a moment.       | <b>Listen, don’t fix</b><br>Save advice for later. “Tell me more” goes a long way.  | <b>Passing is okay</b><br>Anyone can say “pass” and pull another card.                |

Some questions (the hard parts, the worries) can bring up big feelings. Listening is enough. If something your child shares worries you, reach out to your child’s doctor or another trusted professional.

## BEFORE YOU PRINT

# Print, cut and keep

- ✓ **Print at “Actual size” (100%).** Cards are standard poker size, 2.5 × 3.5 in (63.5 × 88.9 mm).
- ✓ **Use cardstock if you can.** Heavy paper or cardstock (65–110 lb / 176–300 gsm) feels like a real deck.
- ✓ **Edges cut off?** Choose “Fit” instead. The cards print a little smaller and still work.
- ✓ **Backs are optional.** Print the backs page on the reverse of a card sheet, flipping on the long edge. Test one sheet first.
- ✓ **Cut on the lines.** A paper trimmer is fastest. Round the corners with a corner punch if you like.
- ✓ **Make them last.** Laminate for sticky fingers. Keep them in a recipe box, a zip bag or on a ring.



9 cards per page · 6 pages · 54 cards

## ✓ Safety basics

- In the car, a passenger reads the card. The driver keeps eyes on the road.
- Bath time: stay with your child. Keep the cards dry in a zip bag by the sink.
- Any question can be skipped. Nobody has to answer something that feels too big.
- If a big worry comes up, listen first. Solutions can wait for a calm moment.
- Laminated cards and card rings stay with grown-ups around babies and toddlers.

## FOUNDER'S NOTE · TO BE WRITTEN BY THE FOUNDER IN HER OWN WORDS BEFORE RELEASE

Placeholder for human-authored text (60–90 words): why these cards exist, how your family uses them, and one favorite question. Replace this box; do not publish with it. See brand/BRAND.md, “Human authorship.”

## Ways to use your deck

### Question jar

One card a night at the dinner table.

### Road-trip stack

A passenger reads; everyone answers.

### Kid picks

Let your child choose the card, or ask it.

### Family favorites

Keep the best ones and ask them again next year.

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START HERE

# How to talk along

- 1 Pick a card that fits the moment.
- 2 Read it out loud.
- 3 Everyone answers, grown-ups too.
- 4 "Pass" is always allowed.

- Dinner
- Car
- Bath
- Bedtime



✓ In the car, a passenger reads. The driver just talks.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

01

**What was the best part of your day?  
What was the trickiest part?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Go first with yours. Kids open up when grown-ups share too.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

02

**If you could invent a brand-new food, what would be in it?  
What would you call it?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Play along with silly answers. Silly keeps the talk going.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

03

**Who made you smile today?  
What did they do?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Listen for new names and ask one more question about them.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

04

**If our family had a holiday that was just ours, what would we do on it?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Write down the best idea, and try it for real.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

05

**What's something you're getting better at?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Notice the effort: "You kept practicing."



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

06

**If you could have dinner with any animal, which one would you pick? What would you talk about?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Ask one follow-up question before you share your own answer.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

07

**What's one thing you'd love to learn how to do?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Ask what the very first step might be.



**Dinner**  
TABLE TALK

08

**If you were in charge of the house for a day, what rule would you make?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**  
Skip the correcting. Ask, "Why that rule?"



## Dinner

TABLE TALK

09

**What's a question you've always wanted to ask me?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Answer honestly and briefly, then ask it back.



## Dinner

TABLE TALK

10

**What made you laugh this week?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Laugh along. Retelling a funny moment is storytelling practice.



## Dinner

TABLE TALK

11

**If you had a superpower just for helping people, what would it be?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Ask who they would help first.



## Dinner

TABLE TALK

12

**Describe your perfect weekend, from breakfast to bedtime.**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for details: "What would it smell like? Sound like?"



## Dinner

TABLE TALK

13

**What's something kind that someone did for you lately?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Say thanks for sharing. It doesn't need to become a lesson.



## Car

A PASSENGER READS

14

**Would you rather drive a bus, fly a plane or sail a boat? Why?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Side-by-side talk feels easy. Eyes on the road is fine.



## Car

A PASSENGER READS

15

**Pick someone you can see outside. Make up a story about where they're going.**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one sentence each.



## Car

A PASSENGER READS

16

**If this car could take us anywhere in one second, where would we go?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they would pack.



## Car

A PASSENGER READS

17

**What song should be our family's theme song?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Let them pick the next song and ask why they like it.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

18

**What's something you're looking forward to?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Share something you're looking forward to as well.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

19

**If you designed a playground, what would it have?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask them to describe it so clearly you could draw it.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

20

**Pick a color. How many things that color can we spot before we get there?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Count out loud together. Younger kids can point.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

21

**What would you do if you were the grown-up and I were the kid today?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Laugh along, then ask what they'd do the same as you.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

22

**What's the hardest part of being a kid right now?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Just listen. "That sounds hard" is enough.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

23

**If animals could talk, which one would be the funniest? What would it say?**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Do the voices together.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

24

**Tell me about a dream you remember.**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask what they think it meant. There are no wrong answers.

**Car**

A PASSENGER READS

25

**What's something you know a lot about? Teach me one thing.**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Be the curious student. Ask a real question.

**Car**

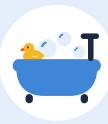
A PASSENGER READS

26

**Think of an animal. I'll ask yes-or-no questions until I guess it.**

**GROWN-UP TIP**

Swap roles so they practice asking the questions.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

27

**If you could swim with any sea creature, which one would you choose?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what it would feel like to touch it.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

28

**What would a fish say about our bathtub?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Answer back in your best fish voice.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

29

**What felt hard today? What helped?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Warm water and a calm voice make this a gentle time to ask.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

30

**If a bubble could carry a message anywhere, what would yours say?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Blow the message away together.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

31

**What's your favorite smell in the whole world? Why?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Share yours. Smells often bring back stories.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

32

**If you were a raindrop, where would you want to land?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask, "And then what happens?"

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

33

**Invent a new bath toy. What does it do?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to give it a name and a sound.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

34

**What makes someone a good friend?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for an example from their day.

**Bath**

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

35

**Would you rather live under the sea or up in the clouds?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask about the trickiest part of living there.



## Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

36

**You just found a new planet. What's its name, and who lives there?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Build the world together, one detail each.



## Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

37

**What's something you like about yourself?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Leave a pause. Then share something you like about them.



## Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

38

**Close your eyes. How many sounds can you hear right now?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Listen quietly first, then compare lists.



## Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

39

**If you shrank to the size of a rubber duck, what would you explore?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Follow their lead and keep asking, "Then what?"



## Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

40

**What are three good things from today?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Keep it small. A snack, a joke or a sunny minute all count.



## Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

41

**What's something you're wondering about?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

"I don't know. Let's find out tomorrow" is a great answer.



## Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

42

**If you could choose tonight's dream, what would it be?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Speak slowly and softly. Calm voices help everyone wind down.



## Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

43

**Who is someone you're thankful for? Why?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Ask if they'd like to tell that person tomorrow.



## Bedtime

WIND-DOWN TALK

44

**What was a brave thing you did this week?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Name the feeling: "You felt nervous, and you did it anyway."

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

45

**What's your favorite memory of our family?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Share one of your favorite memories of them.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

46

**If your stuffed animal could talk, what would it say about your day?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Let the toy answer in its own voice.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

47

**What's something you'd like to do together this weekend?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Pick one idea and put it on the calendar.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

48

**Was there anything that worried you today?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Listen first. Solutions can wait until morning.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

49

**Start a story: "Once upon a time, a tiny dragon..."**



GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one line until someone yawns.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

50

**What would you love to be really good at when you grow up?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they love about it.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

51

**If today were weather, what would it be? Sunny, cloudy, stormy?**



GROWN-UP TIP

Accept every answer. Feelings aren't right or wrong.

**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

52

**What do you want to remember about today?**



GROWN-UP TIP

End with the same goodnight words every night.

MAKE IT YOURS

+

**Your own question**

OUR QUESTION

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GROWN-UP TIP

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For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime



## Talk-Along

Family cards • Ages 5-12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



## Talk-Along

Family cards • Ages 5-12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



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Family cards • Ages 5-12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS



## Talk-Along

Family cards • Ages 5-12

PLAY BEFORE PIXELS

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question



OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question



OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question



OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

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MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question



OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

MAKE IT YOURS

Your own question



OUR QUESTION

GROWN-UP TIP

For: Dinner Car Bath Bedtime

# Where the cards live

Cards get used when they're already in the room. Split the deck into four piles, cut out these labels, and tape each one to a jar, an envelope or a zip bag.



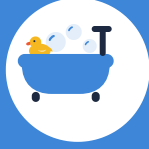
**Dinner**  
TALK-ALONG CARDS 01-13

Keep them in a jar on the table.



**Car**  
TALK-ALONG CARDS 14-26

Keep them in the glove box or a door pocket.



**Bath**  
TALK-ALONG CARDS 27-39

Keep them by the sink in a zip bag.



**Bedtime**  
TALK-ALONG CARDS 40-52

Keep them on the nightstand or by the books.

## Our talk-along week

Check a box each time a card gets asked. Start on any day. Aim for a few checks, not a full grid.

|         | DAY 1                    | DAY 2                    | DAY 3                    | DAY 4                    | DAY 5                    | DAY 6                    | DAY 7                    |
|---------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Dinner  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Car     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Bath    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Bedtime | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

Our family's favorite question so far:

A question we want to add:

# What's next

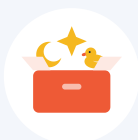


## Your free companion bonus

Scan the code or visit [playbeforepixels.com/bonus/family-talk-along-cards](https://playbeforepixels.com/bonus/family-talk-along-cards) for extra printable cards and a short, friendly idea by email each month.

We ask only for an email address and your child's birth month and year, never names. Unsubscribe any time.

## Next for your family



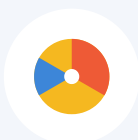
### "I'm Bored" Play Cards

Ages 1–12 · 150 age-banded screen-free plays, each with a talk prompt



### Visual Routine Cards

Ages 0–12 · picture cards for mornings, bedtime and the day in between



### 52 Play & Talk Cards

Ages 0–5 · for the little ones: one play and one talk tip per card

Find them all at [playbeforepixels.com](https://playbeforepixels.com). Bundles are offered at a fair discount.

## Which card did your family love?

A short review on the shop where you bought this helps other families find it. Questions or ideas? Write to us through the contact form at [playbeforepixels.com/contact](https://playbeforepixels.com/contact).



52 Family Talk-Along Cards, Ages 5–12. First edition, 2026. Printable PDF for personal and family use.

Parent education only. These cards are ideas for everyday play and conversation; they are not medical, developmental or professional advice and are not a substitute for care from a qualified professional. Supervise children as right for their age, especially near water and in the car.

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